

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Drew Conclusions

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Drew Conclusions

Art Critic & Cultural Podcaster

Drew calls everything derivative, especially things he likes. Drew can make a museum director nervous with a headline and an artist furious with a compliment.

- Friendly rival of **Paige Turner**.
- Has reviewed **Vincent Van Faux**, **Dada DiCapo**, **Al Baster**, and **Elle Loominate**.
- **Elon Mosaic** remembers an especially brutal line about his collection.

ACTING TIPS

Dry, perceptive, skeptical, socially nimble. Deliver observations as if they occurred to you three minutes before everyone else.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Drew Conclusions. I review art professionally. My expression is not a verdict, but I recommend remaining concerned.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant discovered that you write an anonymous satirical newsletter skewering museum patrons and planned to unmask you during his speech.

Your other secret

Several jokes in the newsletter came from private conversations, and you regret at least one of them.

Conversations to start

- Ask Paige Turner what makes a story worth publishing when a donor objects.
- Ask Vincent Van Faux whether he reads the anonymous museum newsletter. Do not admit you write it.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Televised drama is a distraction. Our drama hides at its back.*
- 2 *The household monument to victory is standing on a secret.*
- 3 *A scarlet stage has a backstage secret. Check behind its fabric.*



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

ACT I: MOTIVE



Drew Conclusions

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The anonymous newsletter is mine. Some jokes came from private conversations, and one hurt somebody who didn't deserve it. Grant planned to expose the author tonight. I was prepared to admit the newsletter. I was considerably less prepared to let him introduce it as a tribute to himself.

IF MURDERER

I wrote the newsletter and used private conversations I should have protected. Grant would unmask me at the gala and have my professional invitations withdrawn. He demanded favorable coverage in exchange. A man unable to recognize satire had finally discovered its author and wished to become its editor.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Drew Conclusions

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Drew Conclusions

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I heckled the naming announcement rehearsal with a line from my anonymous column. Grant recognized it. I then stopped the recording on my phone before the discussion reached the correction he had paid for. That edit was deliberate. I was willing to claim the joke and much less willing to claim the transaction. The printer already had the smaller correction. Grant wanted me to promise him a tribute instead.

IF MURDERER

I heckled the naming announcement rehearsal with a line from my anonymous column. Grant recognized it. I then stopped the recording on my phone before the discussion reached the correction he had paid for. That edit was deliberate. I was willing to claim the joke and much less willing to claim the transaction. The printer already had the smaller correction. Grant wanted me to promise him a tribute instead.



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Drew Conclusions

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Drew Conclusions

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The anonymous column was mine, as was the paid correction. The printer still has the earlier edition and the invoice for the later one. Grant wanted the smaller correction expanded into a tribute. I left the version the printer had already set. Neither edition accuses him of poisoning anyone; both show what I was willing to sell.

IF MURDERER

The anonymous column and the paid correction were mine. Grant wanted a tribute in place of the correction. I left him the smaller paragraph because the tribute would make the payment obvious to every reader. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my newsletter folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass before leaving him the smaller correction.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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ACCUSATIONS



Drew Conclusions

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The column was mine, the correction was paid, and the phone edit concealed that payment. The printer kept the editions and invoice. I did not murder Grant. I will put my name and the transaction beside the correction. Readers can decide how funny they find the original after learning what its author sold.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my newsletter folder when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He wanted the satire turned into his tribute. I killed him rather than admit what I had sold him.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.